OLAYINKA AFOLABI

Emergency Preparedness | Risk Analysis | Humanitarian Coordination

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Emergency preparedness, risk analysis and humanitarian coordination specialist with more than 20 years of experience across UNICEF, international NGOs, the Red Cross movement and Nigeria's national disaster-management institutions. Experienced in connecting multi-hazard analysis with contingency planning, anticipatory action, early warning, emergency coordination, response monitoring and government-led preparedness. Brings national and sub-national experience in fragile, conflict-affected and climate-vulnerable settings, including international UNICEF assignments in Pakistan and South Sudan.

CORE EXPERTISE

Emergency preparedness and response	Contingency planning, emergency procedures, simulations, prepositioning, activation and response monitoring.
Risk analysis and early warning	Multi-hazard analysis, horizon scanning, GIS-supported assessment, anticipatory action and operational mitigation.
Humanitarian coordination	Government partnership, inter-agency planning, emergency task teams, humanitarian access and partner coordination.
Programme and resource management	HAC, grant monitoring, donor reporting, budget oversight, supply readiness and delivery follow-up.
Leadership and capacity strengthening	Crisis coordination, team leadership, training, simulations and institutional capacity development.
Data and digital tools	Power BI, ArcGIS, Microsoft applications, dashboards, mapping and evidence-based decision support.

SELECTED CONTRIBUTIONS

- Provided technical leadership for UNICEF-supported revisions of Nigeria's Countrywide Risk Analysis with NEMA, translating national and sub-national risk evidence into planning products.
- Developed and managed UNICEF Nigeria's Emergency Preparedness Platform from 2019 and supported preparedness monitoring across national and field-office teams.
- Facilitated national and sub-national contingency-plan reviews covering five geopolitical areas and 19 states; supported government-endorsed SOPs and simulation exercises in priority states.
- Led or coordinated UNICEF response support for the 2023 Adamawa flash floods, the 2022 multi-state floods, the January 2024 Plateau conflict crisis and the 2024 Lagos cholera response.
- Managed Oxfam humanitarian projects valued at approximately US$4.5 million and supported timely assistance to more than 10,000 households.
- Contributed to development of the 2022 Nigeria Flood Flash Appeal, supporting approximately US$12 million mobilized for UNICEF response.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Emergency Specialist (NOC)

UNICEF Nigeria, Abuja | August 2017 – Present

- Lead and support emergency preparedness, risk analysis, anticipatory action, early warning, government coordination, contingency planning, simulations, emergency supply readiness, HAC, situation reporting and management decision support.
- Coordinate the UNICEF Nigeria Emergency Technical Team (since August 2025), supporting emergency analysis, action tracking, HCT briefs, HAC and SitRep updates, donor inputs and management follow-up across field offices and programme sections.
- Acted as Emergency Manager for approximately three months in 2021, maintaining day-to-day unit delivery and coordination with senior management and programme teams.
- Supported preparedness and early-warning capacity strengthening with NEMA, NiHSA, NiMet, NASRDA, SEMAs, ministries, departments, agencies and local partners.
- Provided technical support for UNICEF Nigeria's HAC development and monitoring, donor-funded response, grant monitoring, resource mobilization and reporting. Annual HAC funding monitored included US$119m (2025), US$142m (2024), US$137m (2023), US$140m (2022) and US$82m (2021).
- Served as focal person for UNICEF Nigeria contingency stocks and supported decentralized prepositioning and emergency supply planning.

Emergency Specialist (P-4 Surge Assignment)

UNICEF Sindh Field Office, Karachi, Pakistan | April 2023 – July 2023

- Advised on flood-response scale-up, programme monitoring and preparedness following the 2022–2023 Level 2 humanitarian response.
- Developed a risk-based preparedness and response dashboard and activation framework; facilitated preparedness-procedure training for teams in Karachi, Hyderabad and Sukkur.

Emergency Specialist (P-3 Stretch Assignment)

UNICEF South Sudan, Juba | May 2022 – July 2022

- Supported country- and field-office preparedness planning, emergency coordination, programme monitoring and grant-utilization analysis.
- Guided field teams in Bentiu, Jonglei and Malakal on location-specific preparedness plans and strengthened severity mapping with risk and programme information.

Consultant

Development Data Initiative, Yobe State, Nigeria | 2016 – July 2017

- Facilitated collation of inputs to the Yobe State Recovery Plan and disaster-management training for government institutions in Plateau State.

Humanitarian Programme Manager

Oxfam, Maiduguri and Yola, Nigeria | 17 July 2014 – 6 December 2016

- Coordinated humanitarian interventions across five LGAs in Borno and four in Adamawa, overseeing 33 staff and three partner NGOs.
- Managed three integrated projects valued at approximately US$4.5 million and supported assistance to more than 10,000 households; oversaw donor budgets, compliance, programme quality and partner coordination.
- Developed Oxfam Nigeria's Humanitarian Country Strategy and supervised cash-transfer pilots in Michika, Fika and Askira Uba.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Lead Consultant
NEMA–UNDP Joint Project, Abuja, Nigeria | April 2014 – June 2014

- Conducted an institutional disaster-risk-reduction capacity assessment for NEMA and developed a NEMA–SEMA compact for capacity strengthening.

Humanitarian and Security Coordinator
Oxfam, Abuja, Nigeria | 17 July 2012 – 16 July 2014

- Supported establishment of Oxfam's humanitarian programme in Nigeria and state-based contingency planning in Oyo, Cross River, Adamawa, Gombe and Katsina.
- Coordinated the 2012 flood response in Bassa, Kogi State and Isoko South, Delta State; represented Oxfam in humanitarian and security coordination platforms.
- Developed Oxfam Nigeria's Security Strategy and Northeast Security Plan and supported security-incident management.

Disaster Management Officer
International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies (IFRC), West Coast Regional Representation | 15 January 2011 – 22 December 2011

- Managed disaster-management programmes, emergency monitoring, assessments and response support across Nigeria, Benin, Togo and Ghana.
- Supported contingency planning, vulnerability and capacity assessments, disaster-risk-reduction projects, election-crisis response and rapid-response deployments.
- Coordinated IFRC–UNICEF support for Nigeria's first National Contingency Plan and supported WASH response in refugee settings during the 2011 Côte d'Ivoire crisis.

Planning, Research and Forecasting Officer (progression to Chief Officer)
National Emergency Management Agency (NEMA), Abuja, Nigeria | 2 December 2002 – December 2010

- Supported national disaster-management policy, planning, forecasting, risk reduction, emergency assessment and inter-agency programmes.
- Contributed to development of the National Disaster Management Framework, Search and Rescue and Epidemic Evacuation Plan, and Nigeria's first National Contingency Plan.
- Served as focal officer for NEMA–UNICEF and NEMA–UNFPA programmes and supported assessment, training, budget, procurement and logistics work.

EDUCATION

- **Master's**, Disaster Risk Management and Development Studies — Federal University of Technology Minna, Nigeria, 2014.
- **Master of Technology**, Application of Remote Sensing (Geography and GIS) — Federal University of Technology Minna, Nigeria, 2005.
- **Bachelor of Science**, Geography (Geography and Planning) — University of Jos, Nigeria, 1997.

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Dynamic Leadership for Humanitarian Leaders — Harvard Humanitarian Initiative, 2026.
- Professional Scrum Master I — Scrum.org, certified 9 September 2026; verify certification.
- Anticipatory Action 1: Introduction to Gender Responsive and Locally Led Anticipatory Action — CARE Climate and Resilience Academy, completed 28 October 2026.
- PMP preparation course — Zaidan Consulting, 35 hours, August 2025; training completed, not PMP certified.
- Safe and Secure Approaches in Field Environments — UN System Staff College/UNDSS, 2024; UNICEF training in emergency procedures, logistics, cholera preparedness and response; NIMS and Incident Command System courses, U.S. Emergency Management Institute/NEMA.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

2026 Closing Nigeria’s Last-Mile Warning-to-Action Gap

Zenodo, 20 October 2026

2024 Using Humanitarian Data to Guide Risk Analysis, Needs Assessment and Response Prioritisation in Northeast Nigeria

International Journal of Science, Technology & Society, 13 March 2024

2023 Localising Emergency Preparedness through State and Local Emergency Management Institutions in Nigeria

Indian Journal of Environment & Development, 13 October 2023

2023 Coordinating Multi-Hazard Emergencies in Nigeria’s Federal System through the 2023 Adamawa Flood Response

International Journal of Humanities and Information Technology, 13 September 2023

2022 Operational Emergency Preparedness and Contingency Plan Functionality in the 2022 Nigeria Floods

Indian Journal of Environment & Development, 30 December 2022

2021 COVID-19 Preparedness and the Continuity of Essential Humanitarian Services in Borno, Adamawa and Yobe States of Nigeria

International Journal of Science, Technology & Society, 25 June 2021

2019 Humanitarian Coordination in Protracted Conflict and the Evolution of Response Architecture in North East Nigeria from 2014 to 2018

International Journal of Technology, Management and Humanities, 25 September 2019

2017 Humanitarian Access and Programme Delivery for Children in Hard to Reach Areas of North East Nigeria in 2017

International Journal of Humanities and Information Technology, 13 June 2017

SELECTED REPORTS AND TECHNICAL PRODUCTS

- Nigeria Risk Analysis Report 2024 — technical leadership with NEMA Geospatial Center and UNICEF.
- National Overview and National Contingency Plan 2023.
- Yobe State Recovery Plan.
- Institutional Disaster Risk Reduction Capacity Assessment for NEMA and NEMA–SEMA capacity-strengthening compact.
- Economic Recovery Assessment of Northeast Nigeria for the Early Recovery and Livelihood Sector — UNDP.
- Assessment of Disaster Management Issues in Ladduga, Kaduna State, following post-electoral violence — IFRC, 2012.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

International Association of Emergency Managers · Emergency Planning Society · National Society of the Red Cross · International Humanitarian Studies Association

LANGUAGES AND DIGITAL TOOLS

English · Power BI · ArcGIS · Microsoft Office applications · GIS mapping and data visualization